

JoJo and the Big Mess

This is a translation, page by page, of *JoJo and the Big Mess* by Jane O'Connor.

Conventions

Personal Names are phoneticized into Adinjo Journalist, not localized or translated.

- JoJo → JOJO
- Nancy → NÁNSI
- Freddy → FRÈDI
- Frenchy → FRÈNCHI

Cover - Front

Fancy Nancy's Little Sister

kuNÁNSI FÁNSI Kada

ku-NÁNSI FÁNSI kada

ku.'næ:n.si 'fæ:n.si ka.da

GEN-Nancy Fancy little.sister

Nancy's Fancy little sister

“FANCY NANCY's Little Sister”

I Can Read!

Yi aniston'mer!

yi anis-ton-mer

ji a.'nis.ton.mer

1.SG read-PRES-POT

I can read

“I can read”

My First - Shared Reading

Kuyi Winirin - Aniswa Varmel

ku-yi win-irin anis-wa varmel

ku.'ji win.'i.rin a.'nis.wa vaɹ.'mel

GEN-1.SG one-ORD read-GER together

my first reading together

“My First - Reading Together”

JoJo and the Big Mess

JOJO Jalu'ai'dul Ic

JOJO jaluai-dul ic
ʒo.'ʒo ʒa.lu.'ai.dul its
JoJo dirty-much COP.PRES
JoJo very messy is

“JoJo is Very Messy”

Kiss the Cook

Burmetax shul

burme.tax shul
buɹ.'me.tax ʃul
cook-AGENT to.kiss
the cook kiss

“Kiss the one who cooks”

Frenchy

FRÈNCHI

FRÈNCHI
fʁɛn.'tʃi
Frenchy
Frenchy

“Frenchy”

By Jane O'Connor

ma DJÉN Ó'KONOR

ma DJÉN Ó'KONOR
ma 'dʒe:n 'o:.ko.noɹ
ATTRIB Jane O'Connor
by Jane O'Connor

“By Jane O'Connor”

Pictures Based on the Art of Robin Preiss Glasser

Métenu natreinu ma RABÌN PRAIS GLÁSAR borchtolot

méten-u	natrein-u	ma	RABÌN	PRAIS	GLÁSAR	borch-t.ol.ot
'me:.tɛ.nu	na.'tɛj.nu	ma	ra.bɪn	'praɪs	'glæ.saɹ	'boʊtʃ.tol.ot
illustration-PL	artwork-PL	ATTRIB	Robin	Preiss	Glasser	inspire-PAST.PASS
illustrations	artwork	by	Robin	Preiss	Glasser	inspired

“Illustrations inspired by Art from Robin Preiss Glasser”

Cover - Inside

Hooray!

Yahei!

yahei

ja.'hej

joyous.INTJ

hooray

“Hurrah!”

___ Can Read This Book!

___ ba twa aniston'mer!

___ ba twa anis-ton-mer

___ ba twa a.'nis.ton.meɹ

blank.space PROX book read-PRES-POT

___ this book can read

“___ can read this book!”

04 - Hi!

Hi!

Hai!

hai

haj

hi.INTJ

Hi!

“Heya!”

I Am JoJo.

Yi JOJO ic.

yi JOJO ic

ji ʒo.'ʒo its

1.SG JoJo COP.PRES

I JoJo am

“I am JoJo.”

I Make Messes.

Yi anjalu'ainu kasons.

yi	an-jalu-'ainu	kason-s
ji	an.ʒa.lu.'aj.nu	ka.'sons
1.SG	be-mess-PL	make.PRES
I	messes	make

"I make messes."

I Can't Help It!

Yi ba folryacmer!

yi	ba	folr-ya-c-mer
ji	ba	fol.'rʲats.meɪ
1.SG	PROX	stop-NEG-PRES-POT
I	this	can not stop

"I can't stop it!"

05 - Today I cook...

Today I Cook with Nancy.

Bajia yi NÁNSI hort burmeton.

ba-jia	yi	NÁNSI	hort	burme-ton
ba.'ʒja	ji	'næ:n.si	hoɪt	buɪ.'me.ton
PROX-day	1.SG	Nancy	with	cook.PRES
today	I	Nancy	with	cook

"Today I cook with Nancy."

She is My Big Sister.

Fi kuyi sorin ic.

fi	ku-yi	sorin	ic
fi	ku.ji	so.'rin	its
3.SG.F	GEN-1.SG	older.sister	COP.PRES
she	my	big sister	is

"She is my big sister."

06

Oops!

Uwai!

uwai
u.'waj

upset-focus-INTJ

oops

“Oopsie!”

I Make a Mess.

Yi anjalu'ai kasons.

yi	an-jaluai	kason-s
ji	an.ʒa.lu.'aj	ka.'sons
1.SG	be-mess	make-PRES
I	a mess	make

“I make a mess.”

07

Daddy is not Mad.

Popoi èldhai icha.

popo-i	èldhar-ai	ic-ha
po.'poj	ɛl.'ðaj	i.tʃa
papa-AFFECTIONATE	anger-DESC	COP.PRES-NEG
Daddy	angry	is not

“Daddy is not angry.”

Translator's Note: Young Adin often struggle with the approximant form of <r>, especially between vowels. This is rendered here by changing the formal *èldharai* by dropping the rhotic entirely, contracting the word to *èldhai*.

Into the Tub I Go.

Yi yanidij jun hemlétol.

yi	yanid-nij	jun	hemlé-tol
ji	ja.'ni.diʒ	ʒun	hem.'leː.tol
1.SG	bath-place	in	go.to-PASS.PRES
I	bathtub	into	go

“I am put into the bathtub.”

09

Today I Work in the Yard.

Bajia yi konta jun dobraton.

ba-jia	yi	konta	jun	dobra-ton
ba.'ʒia	ji	kon.ta	ʒun	do.bja.ton

this-day	1.SG	field	in	work-PRES
today	I	the yard	in	work

“Today I work in the yard.”

10

Oops!

Uwai!

uwai

u.'waj

Upset-focus-INTJ

oh-my!

“Oopsie!”

I Make a Big Mess.

Yi anjalu'aidul kasons.

yi	<i>an-jaluai-dul</i>	<i>kason-s</i>
ji	an.ʒa.lu.'aj.dul	ka.'sons
1.SG	be-mess-more	make-PRES
I	a big mess	make

“I make a big mess.”

11

Daddy is not Mad.

Popoi èldhai icha.

<i>popo-i</i>	<i>èldh(ar)-ai</i>	<i>ic-ha</i>
po.'poj	el.'ðaj	i.'tʃa
papa-AFFECTIONATE	anger-DESC	COP.PRES-NEG
Daddy	angry	is not

“Daddy is not angry.”

Into the Pool We Go.

Yi furinij jun hemlétol.

yi	<i>furin-nij</i>	<i>jun</i>	<i>hemlé-tol</i>
ji	fu.'ri.niʒ	ʒun	hem.'leː.tol
1.SG	swim-place	in	go.to-PASS.PRES
I	swimming.pool	into	go

“I am put into the pool.”

Later Freddy Comes to Play.

Tèmba kyorel FRÈDI ayginstèn hemléton.

<i>tèmba</i>	<i>kyorel</i>	<i>FRÈDI</i>	<i>aygins-tèn</i>	<i>hemlé-ton</i>
tɛm.ba	'kʲo.rel	fɹɛ.'di	'aj.gin.stɛn	hem.'le:ton
time	after	Freddy	play-GER	come.to-PRES
a while	after	Freddy	playing	comes

“After a while, Freddy comes for playing.”

He is My Pal.

Ji kuyi tatamano ic.

<i>ji</i>	<i>ku-yi</i>	<i>tatamano</i>	<i>ic</i>
ʒi	ku.'ji	ta.ta.ma.'no	its
3M.SG	GEN-1SG	AFF.friend	COP.PRES
he	my	close.friend	is

“He is my buddy.”

We Have a Fight.

Ki leka'e kempos.

<i>ki</i>	<i>leka'e</i>	<i>kempo-s</i>
ki	le.ka.'e	kem.'pos
1PL	fight	do-PRES
we	a fight	do

“We do a fight.”

Translator's Note: The word choice here is important. By saying *leka'e kempos* "do a fight" there is already the implication that this is a form of play, rather a serious conflict. A serious fight would simply use *lekake* "fighting" or a conjugation of that verb.

It is not a Real Fight.

Ba leka'e jurau icha.

<i>ba</i>	<i>leka'e</i>	<i>jur-au</i>	<i>ic-ha</i>
ba	le.ka.'e	ʒu.'rau	i.tʃa
PROX	fight	real-DESC	COP.PRES-NEG
this	fight	real	is not

“This is not a real fight.”

It is a Pillow Fight.

Ba dan leka'e i arushu ic.

<i>ba</i>	<i>dan</i>	<i>leka'e</i>	<i>i</i>	<i>arush-u</i>	<i>ic</i>
ba	dan	le.ka.'e	i	a.'ru:ʃu	<u>its</u>
PROX	INDEF	fight	of	cushion-PL	COP.PRES
this	a	fight	of	cushions	is

“This is a fight of cushions.”

14

Ka-Boom! (x4)

Fa-Fuun!

fa-fuun
fa.'fu:wn
swing.ONOM-soft.thud.ONOM
whack

“Fwa-Whack!”

16

Look! Look!

Zen! Zen!

zen
zen
to.look
Look!

“Look! Look!”

Feathers Are Flying!

Djecinu kirmagella ic!

<i>djeci-nu</i>	<i>kirmagel-la</i>	<i>ic</i>
ḍʒe.'tsi.nu	kiɹ.ma.'gel.la	<u>its</u>
feather-PL	to.fly-DESC	COP.PRES
feathers	flying	are

“Feathers are flying!”

17

We Shake the Pillows.

Ki arushu ufalton varm!

ki	arush-u	ufal-ton	varm
ki	a.'ru.fu	u.fal.ton	vaɪm
1PL	pillow-PL	to.strike-PRES	together
we	pillows	strike	together

"We strike the pillows together."

More Feathers Fly!

Djecinu'dul kirmagelton tak!

djeci-nu-dul	kirmagel-ton	tak
ḍʒe.'tsi.nu.dul	kiɪ.ma.'gel.ton	tak
feather-PL-AMPL	to.fly-PRES	move.away
more feathers	fly	away

"More feathers fly away!"

18

Daddy Comes In.

Popoi aurok ni hemléton.

popo-i	aurok	ni	hemlé-ton
po.'poj	'au.rok	ni	hem.'le:.ton
papa-AFFECTIONATE	room	into	to.move.towards-PRES

"Daddy comes into the room."

This time He is Mad.

Batempa ji èldhai ic.

ba-temba	ji	èldh(ar)-ai	ic
ba.tem.ba	ʒi	el.'ðaj	its
this-time	3M.SG	anger-DESC	COP.PRES
this time	he	angry	is

"This time he is angry."

19

"Clean This Mess up," He Says.

"Ju banjaluai cinu kuretochi," ji yaniton.

ju	ba-an-jaluai	ci-nu	kure-tochi	ji	yani-ton
ʒu	ban.ʒa.lu.'aj	'tsi.nu	ku.'re.to.tʃi	ʒi	ja.'ni.ton
now	this-be-mess	2SG-PL	to.clean-FUT	3.SG.M	say-PRES

now this mess you two will clean he says

"Now you two will clean this mess," he says."

Translator's Note: *Cinu* is the generic plural of the second person *ci*, and does not specifically mean "you two" but "you group." In the context of this page, "you two" is a proper way to refer to the plural.

20

Making a Mess is Fun.

Anjaluai kanoson delmaré ic.

<i>an-jalu-ai</i>	<i>ka-no-son</i>	<i>an-delmaré</i>	<i>ic</i>
<i>an.ʒa.lu.'ai</i>	<i>ka.no.'son</i>	<i>an,del.ma.'re:</i>	<i>its</i>
mess	ma-GER-ke	be-enjoy	COP.PRES
mess	making	enjoyable	is

"Mess making is fun."

21

Cleaning up This Mess is no Fun.

Banjaluai kuresh andelmarya icha.

<i>ba-an-jaluai</i>	<i>kure-sh</i>	<i>an-delmaré-ya</i>	<i>ic-ha</i>
<i>ban.ʒa.lu.'aj</i>	<i>ku.reʃ</i>	<i>an.'del.ma.r'a</i>	<i>i.tʃa</i>
this-be-messy	to.clean-GER	be-enjoy-NEG	COP.PRES
this mess	cleaning	not enjoyable	is not

"Cleaning this mess is very not fun."

Translator's Note: The use of a double negative here is a way of focusing the speaker's attitude, and is entirely proper in Adinjo to strengthen how negative something is.

22

At Last We Are Done.

Agoju ki birtol.

<i>a-goju</i>	<i>ki</i>	<i>bir.tol</i>
<i>a.go.'ʒu</i>	<i>ki</i>	<i>bi.ɬ.tol</i>
UNIV.after	1PL	to.finish-PASSPRES
after everything	we	finish

"In the end, we finish."

Translator's Note: The term *agoju* here would mean something along the lines of "at the end of it all, after everything," or even, "at the very end." It suggests a great effort and amount of time

invested, and is often used to introduce an epilogue or conclusion of a narrative.

23

Freddy and I Are Pooped.

FRÈDI hi yi xamp-xampau ic.

FRÈDI	hi	yi	xamp(e)-xamp(e)-au	ic
fɿɛ.'di	hi	ji	xamp.xamp.'au	its
Freddy	and	1SG	to.stumble-REDUP-DESC	COP.PRES
Freddy	and	I	stumbly-stumbly	are

"Freddy and I are stumbly-wumbly."

We Plop onto the Pillows.

Ki arushu'hem xampetol.

ki	arush-u-hem	xampe-tol
ki	a.'ru.fu.hem	xampetol
1PL	pillow-PL-toward	to.fall-PASS.PRES
we	onto pillows	do fall

"Onto the pillows we fall."

24

Soon We Are Ready for More Fun.

Cir ki andelmaré'dul inda amendon.

cir	ki	an-delmaré-dul	inda	amend-ton
tsiɿ	ki	an,del.ma.'re:.dul	in.da	a.'men.don
soon	we	be-enjoy-AMPL	for	to.wake-PRES
soon	we	more fun	for	wake

"Soon we wake up for more fun."

25

I Say, "I Know Something Fun to do."

Yi yaniton: "Yi yuga andelmaré kenompo ijinton."

yi	yani-ton	yi	yuga	an-delmaré	kempo	ijin-ton
ji	ja.'ni.ton	ji	ju.ga	an,del.ma.'re:	kem.po	i.'zin.ton
1SG	to.say-PRES	1SG	thing	be-enjoy	to.do	to.know-PRES
I	say	I	a thing	fun	to do	know

"I say: 'I know a fun thing to do.'"

We Find Paper.**Ki para airenton.**

ki para airen-ton
 ki pa.ra 'aj.ren.ton
 1PL paper to.find-PRES
 we paper find

*"We find paper."***We Find Paints.****Ki alboru airenton.**

ki albor-u airen-ton
 ki al.'bo.ru 'aj.ren.ton
 1PL paint.PL to.find-PRES
 we paints find

*"We find paints."***We Do not Find Brushes.****Ki doshanu airentona.**

ki dosha.nu airen-ton-ha
 ki do.'fa.nu 'aj.ren.to.na
 1PL paintbrush-PL to.find-PRES-NEG
 we paintbrushes do not find

*"We do not find paintbrushes."***"That's okay," I Say.****"Zazamur," yi yaniton.**

za-zamur yi yani-ton
 za.za.'mu.ɿ ji ja.'ni.ton
 AFF-alright 1S say-PRES
 okey-dokey I say

*"Okey-dokey," I say."***"We Can Use Our hands."**

"Lanki ayenu anetochimer."

<i>lan-ki</i>	<i>aye-nu</i>	<i>ane-tochi-mer</i>
lan.'ki	a.'je.nu	a.'ne.to.tʃi.meɪ
REFL-1PL	hand-PL	to.use-FUT-POT
Our own	hands	are able to use

"We can use our hands."

29

Freddy and I Paint.

FRÈDI hi yi alboton.

<i>FRÈDI</i>	<i>hi</i>	<i>yi</i>	<i>albo-ton</i>
frɛ.'di	hi	ji	al.'bo.ton
Freddy	and	1SG	paint-PRES
Freddy	and	I	paint

"Freddy and I paint."

30

Painting is Fun.

Alboren puru.

<i>alboren</i>	<i>pu-ru</i>
al.bo.'ren	pu.ru
to.coat-GER	enjoy-GER
painting	enjoying

"We enjoy painting."

It is Messy.

Xi anjalu'ai.

<i>xi</i>	<i>an-jalu.ai</i>
xi	an.ʒa.lu.'aj
3SN	be-dirt.ADJ
it	dirty

"It is messy."

It is Pretty!

Xi kekein!

<i>xi</i>	<i>ke.kein</i>
xi	ke.'kejn

3SN AFF.beauty

it so-pretty

"It's so pretty!"

31

"Here."

Banchi.

banchi

ban.'tʃi

gift

gift

"A gift."

"This Is for you," I Tell Daddy.

"Xi banchi incíc," yi popoi hemlé yaniton

xi	banchi	in-ci-ic	yi	popo-i	hemlé	yani-ton
xi	ban.'tʃi	in.'tsits	ji	po.'poj	hem.'le:	ja.'ni.ton
3SN	gift	for-2S-COP.PRES	1S	papa-AFFECTIONATE	toward	speak-PRES
it	a.gift	for-you-is	I	daddy	to	tell

"It's a gift for you," I tell daddy."

32 - He is not Mad Now.

He is not Mad Now.

Ju,ji eldha'ha icha.

ju	ji	èldha(r)-ha	ic-ha
ʒu	ʒi	ɛl.ð̥a.ha	i.tʃa
now	3SM	anger-NEG	COP.PRES-NEG
now	he	anger-not	isn't

"Now, he is not angry."

Translator's Note: This use of the double negative communicates that there has been a change in the anger of *popoi* "daddy," reinforcing that he *was* angry but is *èldhaha* "not angry" anymore.

This is the Best Mess of All.

Banjaluai lan ic'rindyurin.

ba-an-jaluai	lan	ic-rin-dyur-in
ban.ʒa.lu.'aj	lan	its.'rin.d̥u.,rin
this-be-messy	self	COP.PRES-POSQUAL-SUPERLATIVE-INTENSE

this-mess itself is-good-most-good

“This mess is the very best.”

This line uses a nonstandard intensifier "*rindyurin*" which repeats *rin* (well, good) after the superlative *dyur*. This can, however, be interpreted as a young child playing with the language similar to the childish English construction "bestest."